

Prompt / Context / Harness / Loop Engineering

four layers, zooming further out each time

1



PROMPT ENGINEERING

The instructions given to the model

What happens

You define the role, instructions, examples, constraints, and output format to get a better reply.

Inputs (instructions)



Horse Analogy



What you get

Better response, but the horse is still doing nothing in the real world.

No tools. No memory. Just the horse listening.

2



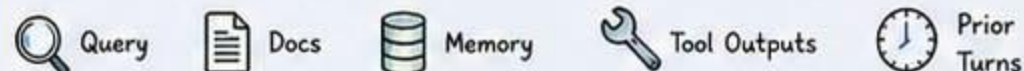
CONTEXT ENGINEERING

The information provided to the model

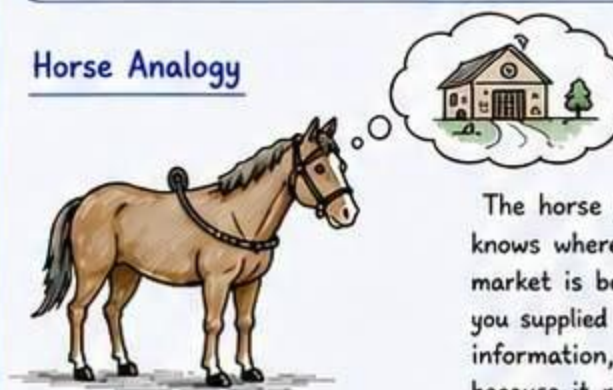
What happens

You provide relevant information so the model understands the situation before deciding what to do.

Inputs (information)



Horse Analogy



The horse now knows where the market is because you supplied the right information, not because it remembered everything itself.

What you get

Smarter answers based on the right information, but still no real action.

The horse knows more, but still not connected to the cart.

3



HARNESS ENGINEERING

Equips and controls one journey

What happens

You wrap the model with tools, memory, execution logic, guardrails, and verification so it can safely perform tasks.

Core components (the harness)



Horse Analogy



What the harness provides

- Connects the horse to the cart
- Gives access to tools & resources
- Lets the driver steer (reins)
- Keeps the horse focused (blinders)
- Checks progress & prevents mistakes
- Stops the horse when needed

The horse is connected to the cart and equipped to work. The driver controls the horse to reach the destination safely.

4



LOOP ENGINEERING

Decides when to start another journey

What happens

Loop engineering is the system that repeatedly launches the harness on new tasks until the overall goal is achieved.

Loop controls (the outer loop)



Horse Analogy (the manager, not the driver)



What you get

The system keeps starting new journeys and completing them until the goal is achieved.

The manager decides when to send the horse again. The horse runs each journey using the harness. No manual steering needed between journeys.

THE BIG PICTURE

Each layer wraps



The model provides intelligence. The harness provides